

Drainage Board Meeting July 9th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=67faOSfWFus
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Drainage Board Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Drainage Board was called to order by the presiding officer, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:01](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Whitehead, Mr. Hamilton, Mr. Christie, Mr. Buckle (also referred to as Mr. Buckwell), Mr. Wright, and Ms. Rian (also referred to as Mr./Ms. A or Mr./Ms. Wigan in roll calls).
 - **Members Absent:** Not specified.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the transcript text, though board members and county officials actively participated.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer [00:00:01](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the July 11th meeting were approved following a motion and proper second.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (All members recorded "Yes") [00:00:30](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:11:28 Petition for Removal of an Obstruction: Wayne John's Property (Dato Area / 350 North)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Wayne John's / Shannon Henry (Delaware County Commissioner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Wayne John's presented a petition regarding a neighbor who built a pond in December and constructed a 4-foot dirt embankment/burm near the property line, blocking the natural overland flow of water and causing severe drainage issues and yard flooding. The County Surveyor noted the burm blocks the overland flow and outlined the legal steps involving registered letters and a public hearing. Commissioners also noted that this highlights the urgent need for the county's pending pond ordinance.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Wayne John's (00:06:55) detailed the history of the unmanaged pond construction and the blocked runoff. Shannon Henry (00:06:12) introduced the complaint and noted a lack of oversight on unpermitted pond digging.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to hold a public hearing on this issue at the next drainage board meeting. Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) 00:11:28.
- **00:09:09 Engineering Services Contract: Abe McConnell Reconstruction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor (Tommy / Tom).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Surveyor presented proposals from two engineering firms, Banning Engineering and Loch Mueller Group, for engineering services on the Abe McConnell reconstruction project. Banning Engineering tailored their estimate specifically to the project (\$23,900 for the design phase), while Loch Mueller provided an hourly rate structure with a "not to exceed \$100,000" pot. Board members favored Banning Engineering due to their familiarity with the project and firm numbers for budgeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to hire Banning Engineering. Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) 00:36:09.
- **00:34:45 Bidding & Quotes: Hyatt and ShraMM Ditches**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Surveyor opened quotes for maintenance/milling work on the Hyatt and ShraMM ditches after soliciting four contractors (two picked up specs, one submitted quotes). Butler Masonry submitted quotes of \$20,235 for the Hyatt ditch and \$17,300 for the ShraMM ditch.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to accept Butler Masonry's quotes for both the Hyatt and ShraMM repair work. Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) 00:38:45.
- **00:39:18 Tile Tie-In Request: Bowers Ditch (Mr. Wright for Mr. Shawer)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Abrite requested a tile tie-in to the Bowers ditch to field-tile a 36-acre field for Mr. Shawer. The Surveyor inspected the area, noted that neighboring western fields tiled last year experienced no ill effects, and recommended approval.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve Mr. Wright's request to tie into the Bowers ditch. Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:40:13](#).
- **[00:40:44](#) Old Business / Contractor Review: Racer Ditch Debrushing Contract (Brian Arnold / Arnold's Landscaping)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Brian Arnold.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Surveyor reported that Arnold's Landscaping was awarded a 90-day contract on April 9th to brush/clear the Racer Ditch, but the work remains incomplete past the July 8th deadline. Issues raised included lack of communication, incomplete tree/stump removal, and neighbor noise complaints regarding late-night work. Contractor Brian Arnold cited weather delays in May and equipment breakdowns.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Brian Arnold ([00:43:13](#)) explained weather and mechanical setbacks and requested an opportunity to finish.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to issue a one-time 30-day extension for Mr. Arnold to complete the work as required, with daily communication mandated with the surveyor's office, failing which payment will be withheld. Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:50:18](#).
- **[00:52:46](#) Petition for Watershed Study: Brown Ditch (Centennial / Route 32 and 700 East)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** David How / County Surveyor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** David How presented a petition with two signatures representing primary landowners to initiate a study of the watershed for the south end of the Brown Ditch to improve a non-functioning open ditch. The Surveyor confirmed the petition meets state code requirements for 10% landowner support by area based on significant land tracks.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** David How ([00:52:56](#)) presented the petition for the watershed study.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to move forward with the public hearing process at the next meeting to address the reconstruction of the ditch. Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:54:26](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **[00:01:07](#) Rome Page** (1713 South Franklin Street, Muncie / Property at 6701 East Hickory Lane):

- Addressed flooding issues caused by a non-regulated storm drain in front of his recently purchased property, noting water accumulation over 7 inches, property damage, and inability to sell the house. County officials (Commissioner Henry and the Surveyor) agreed to investigate the outflow and coordinate tile repairs starting from the nearby regulated ditch.
- **00:14:58 Susan Kemp** (1501 North Stockport Drive, Muncie):
 - Addressed concerns regarding a deteriorating private culvert/structure over a regulated ditch on Stockport Drive. Expressed anxiety over a county/sanitary district agreement letter requiring residents to assume future maintenance liabilities, noting residents are elderly and on fixed incomes. Commissioners Bran and Henry clarified that the county and Muncie Sanitary District offered a one-time \$15,000 fix for life-safety and emergency vehicle access, but residents must sign off acknowledging private responsibility for their driveways.
- **00:26:24 Ma'am Parkson** (1315 North Stockport Drive):
 - Spoke regarding the Stockport Drive culvert issue, echoing Susan Kemp's concerns about placing maintenance financial burdens on residents who did not originally construct the ditch or bridge, and questioning the equity of the proposed agreement terms.
- **00:52:46 David How** (12261 South County Road 600 West, Middletown):
 - Appeared before the board to officially submit a petition for a watershed study on the Brown Ditch (action detailed under Substantive Business).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Board members promoted the county fair (**00:54:55**).
 - Announcement that the Indiana State Farm Bureau Drainage School is scheduled for August 26th (registration opens July 22nd), with the Delaware County Farm Bureau covering registration fees for the surveyor's office and drainage board members **00:55:08**.
- **Maintenance Claims:** Approval of maintenance claims moved, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote 00:55:31**.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion and a unanimous voice vote **00:55:50**.